

Citizenship

A citizen is an inhabitant of a country in which they were born or where they live. Each country has its own rules and beliefs about the roles of citizens and what it means to be a good citizen. It is important for teens to explore their role in society.

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Understanding citizenship

Every individual is a member of a country, usually the country in which they live or were born. Citizens are granted certain freedoms and privileges, such as access to education and healthcare, specific to their country's law. In return, a citizen has obligations to their country, including paying taxes and abiding by laws. A citizen is part of a community, and active citizenship supports and adds to society and country.



► Give and take

Being a citizen grants individuals certain rights, and expects certain commitments and duties in return.

Citizenship values

A good citizen thinks and acts to uphold the law, is informed about issues relating to the community, and supports the values of good citizenship:

Responsibility

Citizens have personal and public responsibilities. To carry these out, a person's first responsibility is to learn, so that they can act in an informed and educated way.

Respect

Good citizens, first and foremost, have respect for themselves. They show respect for other people, the country's laws, and the environment in which they live.

Tolerance

Showing respect, awareness, and appreciation for the differences, as well as the common likenesses, between individuals and groups of people is part of citizenship.

Honesty

Honesty is the cornerstone of good citizenship, as it facilitates moral behavior. Good citizens are honest with themselves, as well as with others.

Compassion

A sense of compassion encourages citizens to care about the well-being of other people and living things, and motivates them to act against suffering and injustice.

Courage

A good citizen shows strength of mind in the face of adversity. This courage means that they do not lose sight of what is good and right, and that they will fight for it.